

US 114051 · SO 1 · NQF LEVEL 5 · 4 CREDITS

Knowledge of Technical Practitioners Meetings



Meeting types and their uses, leadership styles, decision-making processes and the conventions that keep meetings fair

TIME	SESSION	MODULE	QUALITY ASSURANCE
90-minute lessons · Self & Group	Friday, 4 Sep 2026 · 09h00 – 14h00	Module 1 · Personal Development	QCTO / MICT SETA

SPECIFIC OUTCOME 1 & ASSESSMENT CRITERIA

What you must be able to demonstrate

Demonstrate knowledge of different types of technical practitioners meetings. You will be assessed against these criteria:



Meeting types & uses

Contract meetings, technical review meetings and project review meetings.



Leadership styles

Democratic, autocratic and facilitative meeting procedures.



Decision-making processes

Voting, consensus, criteria-based rating, ranking, paired comparisons.



Meeting conventions

Moving, seconding, amending and voting procedures.



The note taker

Why the note taker requires a technical background.



Why it matters

Meetings are where technical teams decide, plan and stay accountable.

Why technical practitioners meet

- Meetings are very important for the work of any organisation — they are where the technical team decides, plans and holds itself accountable.
- Good meetings support collective decision-making, planning and follow-up, accountability and democracy.
- The principal activities of a technical committee are the development and maintenance of its standards, technical reports and data files.
- A badly run meeting wastes the scarcest resource a technical team has — its practitioners' time.



By the end of this unit you will have prepared, chaired and minuted a technical practitioners meeting yourself — that is the evidence in your logbook.

Three meetings you must know

Organisations hold many kinds of meetings — general members, special, executive, AGMs. For technical practitioners, three types matter most:



Contract meetings

Discuss, review and manage contractual obligations and deliverables related to technical projects or services.



Technical review meetings

Evaluate technical solutions, designs and implementations, and resolve technical issues and problems.



Project review meetings

Assess project progress, timelines, resource allocation and project deliverables.

Which meeting, when?

Meeting	Typical use	Example
Contract meeting	Negotiate or review a contract, SLA or deliverable with a client or supplier	Quarterly SLA review with the support vendor
Technical review	Evaluate a design, system or implementation against requirements and standards	Design review before a network upgrade
Project review	Track progress, risks, resources and milestones on a running project	Month-end review of the LAN rollout project

Who decides — the chair, the group, or both?

Three main leadership styles are used in meeting procedures. Choose the style that fits the meeting's purpose:



Democratic

Appointed or nominated delegates all have a voice and participate in decision-making — the chair guides the process, the group decides.



Autocratic

The chairperson runs the entire meeting and gives most of the input; attendees contribute only when instructed. Fast — use with care.



Facilitative

A group effort: the facilitator ensures all members actively participate to reach the outcome, guiding while staying neutral.

Matching the style to the meeting

Style	Who decides	Best when
Democratic	The members, by discussion and vote	Decisions need buy-in from every department or area represented
Autocratic	The chairperson	Time is critical, or one accountable owner must direct the outcome
Facilitative	The group, guided by a neutral facilitator	Ideas and problem-solving matter more than a formal ruling

Five ways meetings reach a decision

Voting

Show of hands or ballot; the most votes wins — simple majority (50% + 1) or supermajority.

Consensus

Discussion and compromise continue until every member can accept the decision.

Criteria-based rating

Rate each option against predetermined criteria; the best total score wins.

Ranking

Rank options best to worst; scores per position are totalled across participants.

Paired comparisons

Compare options two at a time; the option preferred most often is selected.

Match the process

Pick the process that fits the decision's importance, urgency and need for buy-in.

Order, fairness and effective decisions



Moving

Formally propose a motion for the meeting to consider.



Seconding

A second member supports the motion — unseconded motions fall away.



Amending

Modify the motion before the vote; amendments are voted on first.



Voting procedures

Show of hands, ballot or poll — counted and recorded by the chair.



The note taker needs a technical background — minutes must capture the terminology, decisions and reasons accurately.

Your work for Specific Outcome 1



Questioning session

“Types of meetings, leadership styles and decision processes”
— typed answers, AI-marked.



Quizzes 1 & 2

Meeting types & leadership styles · decision-making & conventions. 80%+ is competent.



Gate quizzes

Answer each lesson's gate quiz as you work through lessons 1–5 on the Lesson tab.



Know the meeting before you run the meeting.

Contract, technical review and project review meetings » democratic, autocratic and facilitative styles » five decision processes » the conventions that keep it fair — the knowledge every chairperson stands on.